

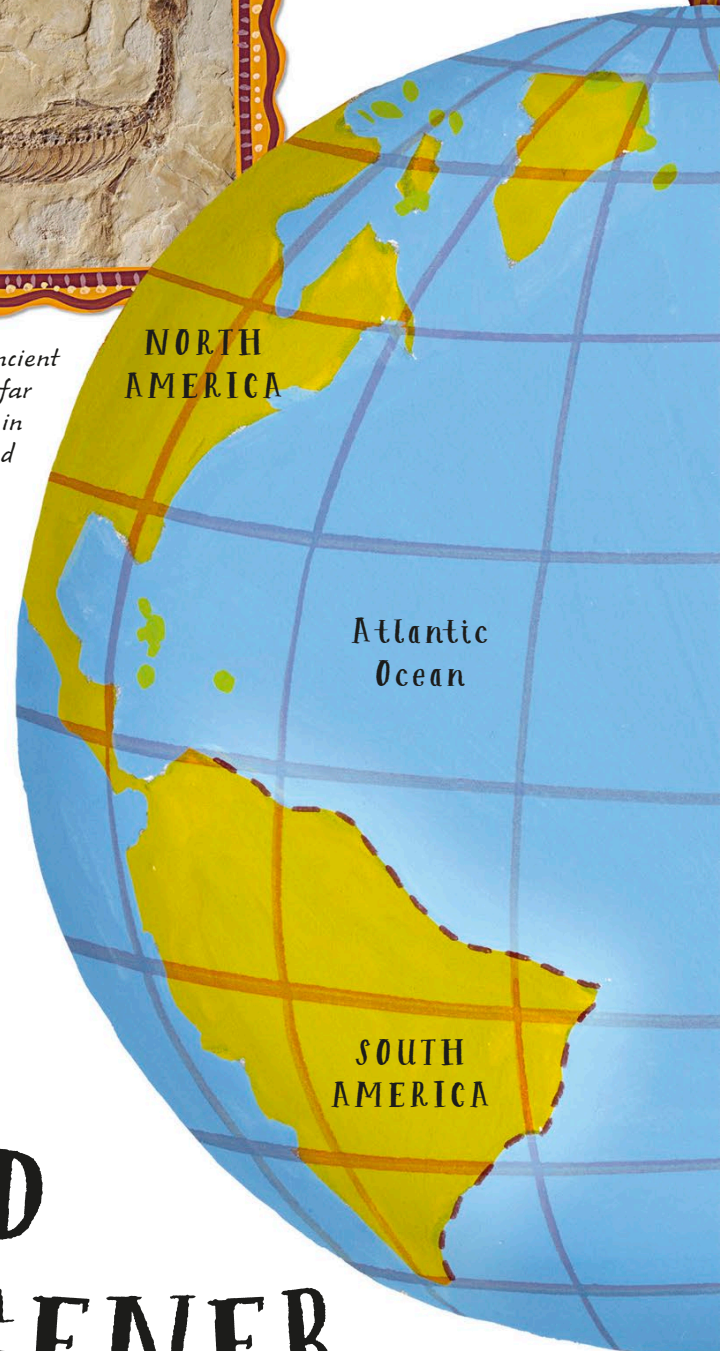
Alfred Wegener began his science career as an astronomer, staring into space. However, he soon became more interested in the fascinating things he saw on our own planet.

Alfred became a professor of Earth sciences, seeking to understand our planet inside and out. One of the strangest things he noticed was how well the coastlines of North America and South America matched up with the coastlines of Europe and Africa, like pieces of a giant jigsaw puzzle. Alfred was amazed to learn that the fossils of similar animals had been found on opposite sides of the huge Atlantic Ocean.

Other scientists had thought that this was because ancient animals had crossed “land bridges” that once connected the continents. But Alfred had a theory—it wasn’t the animals that had moved, it was the continents themselves!



Fossils of Mesosaurus, an ancient reptile, have been found far away from each other—in both southern Africa and South America.



ALFRED WEGENER

German meteorologist, geophysicist,
and polar explorer • 1880–1930

